organizations; we include in the appendix a summary table of those we interviewed. Meanwhile, our case studies illustrate the breadth of IOs and populist leaders covered by our theoretical framework, grounding our arguments in real-world contexts. Finally, systematic regression analyses allow us to examine trends across countries and over time, ensuring the robustness of our findings.

By employing this multi-method approach, we demonstrate the generalizability of our framework across diverse IOs and political environments. We hope these data and methodologies will inspire future work on IO resilience, populist disruption, and the broader dynamics of international cooperation. In the concluding chapter, we outline potential directions for future research, emphasizing how our datasets and theoretical contributions can inform the study of populism, IO behavior, and global governance more broadly. By capturing the nuanced interplay between populist actors and multilateral institutions, this project not only advances our understanding of a pressing global issue but also provides tools for scholars to deepen their exploration of these dynamics.

1.7.3 Practitioners

Our study examines the defensive measures that IOs deploy to counter populist pressures, holding implications for how IOs can prepare for challenges in the present and future. As populist movements continue to hold sway in diverse political contexts, it is imperative for IOs to strengthen their defenses proactively. We thus offer practical recommendations for policymakers and practitioners committed to preserving and enhancing the role of international institutions. By clarifying the trade-offs of various strategies and proposing a cohesive approach, we offer suggestions to help IOs move toward long-term resilience.

Drawing on the framework of defensive strategies outlined in this book, we argue that IOs should adopt tools from all four categories of responses in concert: sidelining populist leaders, appeasing them, sidelining their constituents, and engaging their constituents. While some strategies are well established in IO playbooks, others have been underutilized, often dismissed as too costly, counterproductive, or unfeasible. However, we contend that a balanced and integrated use of these tools offers the best path forward,